

Accumulated Small Fortune Death Ends Colorful Career of Prisoner

Huntsville (AP)—The death of a 71-year-old inmate at the Ellis Unit, Texas Department of Corrections, ended a colorful chapter in the life of James C. Cowboy Palmer, who had been in prison in Texas since March 1, 1935.

Palmer, in nearly 35 years as a prison inmate, had been a champion horse rider for the annual Texas Prison Rodeo up until old age made him give up this sport six years ago.

Albert Moore, director of the rodeo, recalled that the first time Palmer performed in the event in Oct. 1936, the 5'8" convict who weighed 135 pounds, came close to death when a bronco dragged him all over the arena.

Misses Death
When we reached Palmer, Moore related, "we were certain he was dead. But in minutes, Palmer got off the ground, shook himself a bit and said he 'felt fine'."

But performing at the prison rodeo was just one of Palmer's prison achievements. Assigned to the prison shoe shop, Palmer learned how to make boots, saddles, belts and purses which he turned into a profitable spare time business.

The fact that at the time of his death he had \$14.50 on deposit in a Houston bank, plus around \$400 in the prison's inmate trust fund, is proof that he had leather goods manufacturing business was a money-making venture in prison.

In addition to the cash, Palmer had 14 saddles on display at the Ellis Unit, Warden C. L. McDams said, valued at around \$200.

His death was due to a heart attack which Palmer suffered while on duty at the Ellis chapel. As he was being taken to the unit hospital, an officer ordered Palmer as saying, "and now they can't hang up a Palmer died within seven minutes."

Indicted in Slaying
What Palmer was referring to was the fact that he was indicted in Monticello, Utah, for the 1935 slaying of two men. In Utah, the death penalty means death by hanging—and Palmer had this fear on his mind since that time.

His imprisonment in Texas followed his conviction in Hunt County for the slaying of a Hopkins County man, termed the "skeleton murder case." The case was transferred to Hunt County where a district court judge gave him a 10-year prison term.

During Palmer's prison stay, friends had made attempts to get him out of prison on parole, however, each time he refused the parole, knowing that it would mean going back to Utah to stand trial for a double murder.

Delivered Sermons
Warren McDams said that in the last few years Palmer became religious and often during his duties at the chapel, he would deliver sermons to other inmates.

It was only a week ago, McDams said, that Palmer told him, "It took me more than 30 years to get into the door of the Lord's House."

Right now, prison officials are attempting to locate relatives and friends of Palmer's who were on his approved correspondence list so that funeral arrangements could be completed. The body is at the Huntsville Funeral home.

If relatives or friends cannot be located, a prison spokesman said, Palmer will be buried in a pauper's grave in the prison cemetery at Huntsville.

Then there is the problem of what will happen to Palmer's estate. To this, most prison officials feel that once the word gets out that Palmer left an estate, "many relatives will show up."

\$100,000 U.S. Gift To U.N. Honors Adlai
United Nations, N.Y. (AP)—The United States gave the UN Institute for Training and Research \$100,000 Friday to pay for the third year of fellowships in memory of Adlai E. Stevenson.

The Stevenson fellowships, chosen from around the world, spend 10 months in New York taking UNTRAR courses, doing research, attending UN meetings or working in the secretariat.



Photo by Tom Corbett, Chronicle Staff

THE HEAD BONE CONNECTED TO . . .

Arthur Pugh of the Houston museum consultant firm bearing his name holds the first cast of a dinosaur head made from molds he has acquired. The molds, made from a dinosaur skeleton found in 1961, will be used to cast a skeleton replica for the Houston Museum of Natural Science. Also to be used

in the reconstruction are 65 bones now owned by the museum. The whole skeleton contains 627 bones. Pugh estimates it will take 18 months to two years to complete the project. He first plans to cast a skeleton for the Rocky Mount, N.C., museum.

Violence in Harris County

HOMICIDES
John D. Hardy, 32, of 1415 Dany was found shot to death in front of his residence about 4 a.m. Saturday. There are no suspects.

ROBBERIES SATURDAY
U-Turn Store, 402 S. Park, robbed of \$65 by two knife-wielding men at 1:15 a.m. Black Cat Tavern, 2417 River-side was robbed of \$100 by two gunmen at 1:15 a.m. Kayo Service Station, 6320 S. Park, was robbed of \$53 by knife-wielding men at 1:16 a.m.

Dobb's House, 3013 W. Alabama, was robbed of \$27 by a gunman at 1:30 a.m. Comopolitan Apartments of 7245 Scott, was robbed of an undetermined amount by two gunmen at 1:30 p.m.

BURGLARIES
There were 51 burglaries reported in Houston Saturday.

Bolivia Acts On Plot Report
La Paz, Bolivia (AP)—President Rene Barrientos suspended constitutional guarantees Saturday after announcing discovery of what he called a subversive conspiracy against his government by various opposition groups.

Declaring a state of siege, the government arrested a number of opposition political leaders, mainly of the previously ruling National Revolutionary Movement.

The government said extremists rightists were conspiring against it, as well as "pro-Fidel Castro groups" and some military men.

To Eat or Not To Eat Before Going to Sleep?

Some people blame a poor night's sleep on eating before retiring. Others insist they sleep better if they have a snack.

A study conducted in Milwaukee tested 27 men in a monastery. About half were given cereal, sugar and milk before bedtime, the other half nothing.

Then the roles were reversed. Bed movements were recorded each night and all answered a questionnaire on how well they slept.

The result: No difference. The study also showed that most people are poor judges of how restless they were. Their estimates of sleep soundness did not correlate well with their actual movements.

Uvalde Legislative Election Set Feb. 11
Austin (AP)—Gov. John Connally set an election Saturday for Feb. 11 to fill the vacancy created by the death of Rep. B. C. Howard of Uvalde.

They Turn Their Backs on Traditions Indians Leave Reservations For Life in Texas' Big Cities

Dallas (AP)—They break with the deep-rooted family ties, the traditions of many centuries, and turn their backs on the old ways.

From the Everglades of Florida to the snow-covered fishing villages of Alaska's Aleutian Islands, they come to Dallas and Fort Worth.

Despite the different languages, customs and backgrounds, they seek a common goal: A place in modern society.

They are Indians. Choctaw and Cherokee from Oklahoma, Hopi and Navaho from Arizona, Blackfeet from the Northwest.

Grosvontes from North Dakota. And most of them face a wrenching readjustment. They are assisted in their strange migration from reservations to Texas big cities through the Bureau of Indian Affairs (BIA) employment assistance branch in Dallas.

The head of the office, Robert Beames, is himself quarter Choctaw and a direct descendant of Sam Houston.

Beames said that in the last year his agency helped relocate 400 single adults and families. He estimated that in the Dallas-Fort Worth area there are 700 to 800 Indians.

Beames' office arranges to train the Indian in a skill, find him a job and give him and his family enough money to live on until he can become self-supporting.

"Indian people have very close family ties and they miss the relatives back at home," Beames said. "Homelessness is the No. 1 reason they leave the city."

A lot of them will learn a skill and then go back home and get a job. Maybe they won't make as much money, but they are nearer to their people.

Beames recounted the story of the Alaskan Eskimo who became a skilled welder in a few short months, then suddenly returned to his fishing village.

"The cars, the noise," he said, "I have to go where it is quiet."

"I would guess 25 to 30 percent of those who complete their courses go back home within a year," Beames said. "But most of them eventually come back because they can't find work back home in the trade they have learned."

The BIA director said it is an exception if his office places an Indian anywhere in Texas but the Dallas-Fort Worth area. He said that except for the few who had been placed in Houston as welders or in the shipyards, the Indians had relocated in Dallas, Fort Worth or the cluster of nearby suburbs.

He lacks the personnel to counsel the Indians if they are scattered across the state.

"We have no difficulty in locating a job for someone who is able and willing to work," Beames said.

"It is the younger Indians who are most eager to try the big city life."

"Younger people are more mobile. They're more willing to go where there's a job and more desirous to break the bonds of the reservation. They are more interested in what's going on in the outside world than their grandparents are."

"Many of them see there is not much economic opportunity on the reservation," Beames explained.

Their education ranges from the second grade level to college degrees. The average educational level is the 10th grade, he said. They train as beauticians, stenographers, X-ray technicians and auto mechanics.

Students to Repair, Paint Valley Churches, Missions

Abilene—Attempting to preserve their religious beliefs, over 100 Sunday School teachers, 100 hardy students are planning to spend their mid-term holiday, Jan. 23-26, repairing and painting buildings and conducting religious ceremonies.

The movement, Operation Helping Hand, is intended to assist several churches and missions in the Rio Grande Valley. The students will be donating their vacation, money and post-exam energy to the effort.

"Our reward is our work doing something constructive," said one student.

"The purpose is to communicate to others without words," said sponsor Marshall Walker, director of religious activities at NASU. "Students want to put words and beliefs into form."

He wants to reduce travel time between his project, funeral home and a cemetery where, he says, most area burials occur.

The board book the request under advisement.

SHORTER TRIP TO CEMETERY?

Philadelphia (AP)—Many people may think the trip to the cemetery may be too short, but undertaker Stanley Winant contends it's too long.

He appeared before the zoning board of adjustment in his efforts to erect a \$100,000 funeral parlor in a location where some 15 persons have voiced objections.

He wants to reduce travel time between his project, funeral home and a cemetery where, he says, most area burials occur.

The board book the request under advisement.

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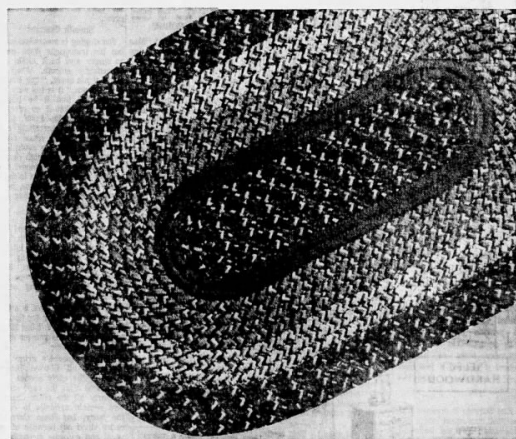
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